Answer key

SAT Practice Test 1, Reading and Writing

Module 1

NO.	ANSWER	SKILL
1	**B**	Words in context
2	**A**	Words in context
3	**C**	Words in context
4	**D**	Words in context
5	**C**	Text structure and purpose
6	**D**	Text structure and purpose
7	**B**	Cross-text connections
8	**A**	Central ideas and details
9	**C**	Central ideas and details
10	**A**	Inferences
11	**D**	Inferences
12	**D**	Command of evidence: textual
13	**C**	Command of evidence: textual
14	**B**	Command of evidence: quantitative
15	**A**	Command of evidence: quantitative
16	**C**	Boundaries
17	**B**	Form, structure, and sense
18	**D**	Form, structure, and sense
19	**B**	Form, structure, and sense
20	**A**	Boundaries
21	**C**	Boundaries
22	**D**	Transitions
23	**B**	Transitions
24	**A**	Transitions
25	**C**	Rhetorical synthesis
26	**A**	Rhetorical synthesis
27	**C**	Rhetorical synthesis

Module 2

NO.	ANSWER	SKILL
1	**B**	Words in context
2	**D**	Words in context
3	**A**	Words in context
4	**C**	Words in context
5	**D**	Text structure and purpose
6	**C**	Text structure and purpose
7	**D**	Cross-text connections
8	**B**	Central ideas and details
9	**A**	Central ideas and details
10	**C**	Command of evidence: quantitative
11	**D**	Command of evidence: quantitative
12	**A**	Command of evidence: textual
13	**C**	Command of evidence: textual
14	**C**	Inferences
15	**B**	Inferences
16	**D**	Form, structure, and sense
17	**D**	Boundaries
18	**A**	Form, structure, and sense
19	**B**	Form, structure, and sense
20	**C**	Boundaries
21	**D**	Boundaries
22	**C**	Transitions
23	**B**	Transitions
24	**A**	Transitions
25	**B**	Rhetorical synthesis
26	**D**	Rhetorical synthesis
27	**C**	Rhetorical synthesis

Answer key

SAT Practice Test 1, Math

Module 1

NO.	ANSWER	SKILL
1	**B**	Data analysis
2	**B**	Percentages
3	**C**	Linear equations
4	**A**	Linear equations in context
5	**C**	Systems of equations
6	**D**	Functions
7	**C**	Triangles
8	**D**	Probability
9	**B**	Statistics
10	**C**	Scatterplots
11	**A**	Inequalities
12	**D**	Functions
13	**B**	Exponential functions
14	**B**	Systems of equations in context
15	**C**	Radicals
16	**A**	Linear functions
17	**28**	Linear equations
18	**63**	Area
19	**30**	Percent change
20	**8**	Quadratics
21	**90**	Volume
22	**12**	Right triangles

Module 2

NO.	ANSWER	SKILL
1	**D**	Functions
2	**A**	Systems of equations
3	**C**	Quadratics
4	**B**	Percentages
5	**D**	Exponential functions
6	**C**	Linear functions
7	**A**	Scatterplots
8	**B**	Surface area
9	**A**	Circles
10	**C**	Trigonometry
11	**D**	Percentages
12	**B**	Absolute value
13	**D**	Exponential equations
14	**B**	Percentages
15	**C**	Exponential functions
16	**A**	Statistics
17	**22**	Systems of equations
18	**4**	Quadratics
19	**4**	Circles in the plane
20	**26**	Quadratics
21	**10**	Quadratics
22	**8**	Systems with nonlinear equations

Score yourself. Count the questions you got right in each module.

Reading and Writing, Module 1: ___ of 27

Module 2: ___ of 27

Math, Module 1: ___ of 22

Module 2: ___ of 22

Answer explanations

SAT Practice Test 1, Reading and Writing, Module 1

Questions 1 to 14

1 **Choice B** Words in context

The colon explains the blank: the light draws smaller fish close. To attract is to draw something near. Repel is the reverse, and the lure is not described as copying or hiding anything.

2 **Choice A** Words in context

Readers who gave up on the book found the timelines more of a burden than a pleasure. Disorienting fits; engaging and predictable would not lead readers to abandon the book.

3 **Choice C** Words in context

The sentence contrasts decorative with something that does a job, and the colon names the job: strengthening social ties. Functional is the only choice that makes that contrast.

4 **Choice D** Words in context

Even though introduces a contrast with the cheaper option of modern pigments, so the curators kept the original colours. Preserve means to keep unchanged.

5 **Choice C** Text structure and purpose

Odile says the job is temporary, yet the final sentence reveals she would be sorry to give it up. That tension is the point of the passage. Nothing suggests resentment, and the lamps are background, not the subject.

6 **Choice D** Text structure and purpose

The first four lines catalogue sounds. The turn at "But here" reveals comfort instead of annoyance. No past event, complaint or questions appear.

7 **Choice B** Cross-text connections

The Text 2 researcher found remote work lowered output for teams that rely on unplanned conversation, so the general claim misses those cases. The researcher does not dispute that people feel less distracted.

8 **Choice A** Central ideas and details

The passage overturns the mating explanation and replaces it with a warning function. The other choices state things the text never claims, and one reverses its findings.

9 **Choice C** Central ideas and details

Marcus expects the cafeteria to be something to endure, yet the silence he shares does not feel like loneliness. He is surprised, not resentful, and no invitation or decision to leave appears.

10 **Choice A** Inferences

If the originals depend on gestures and taste, a written record without quantities can only come close. The other choices contradict the logic of the passage.

11 **Choice D** Inferences

If the necks were held low, reaching treetops cannot have been their only job, so another purpose is likely. The analysis says nothing about diet, movement or how often bones are found.

12 **Choice D** Command of evidence: textual

Removing otters and seeing urchins rise and kelp fall tests the chain Ferrante proposes. The other findings do not connect otters to kelp through urchins.

13 **Choice C** Command of evidence: textual

Dara says she is fine, but her harder and harder placing of the chairs shows what she feels. In the other choices, feelings are stated outright or not shown at all.

14 **Choice B** Command of evidence: quantitative

The lowest bar is the 12 to 17 group, at about 410. The other choices name groups with higher bars.

Answer explanations

SAT Practice Test 1, Reading and Writing, Module 1

Questions 15 to 27

15 **Choice A** **Command of evidence: quantitative**

Granny Smith is lowest for sweetness yet highest for crispness, so the two do not move together. The other choices either do not compare the two ratings or show them rising together.

16 **Choice C** **Boundaries**

Two complete sentences cannot be joined by a comma alone or with no punctuation. A semicolon joins them correctly. A semicolon followed by and is not standard.

17 **Choice B** **Form, structure, and sense**

The subject is the singular collection, not the plural word soldiers in the phrase after it, so the verb must be singular and present: is.

18 **Choice D** **Form, structure, and sense**

The collecting was completed before another past event (the festival ending), which calls for the past perfect: had collected.

19 **Choice B** **Form, structure, and sense**

The proposals belong to the two boards, a plural noun, so the plural possessive boards' is needed. Board's would belong to a single board.

20 **Choice A** **Boundaries**

The phrase a plant native to alpine meadows is extra information about the edelweiss, so it must be set off by a pair of commas, one before and one after.

21 **Choice C** **Boundaries**

A complete sentence followed by a list that explains it takes a colon. A comma or no mark would blur the boundary, and a semicolon is used between independent clauses.

22 **Choice D** **Transitions**

The failure would normally discourage her, but she kept going, which is a contrast. Nevertheless signals that contrast.

23 **Choice B** **Transitions**

The second sentence adds a further benefit to the first, so an additive transition such as Moreover fits. However and Instead would signal a contrast.

24 **Choice A** **Transitions**

Mirrors were introduced in response to the blurring described in the first sentence. To address this problem links the two ideas.

25 **Choice C** **Rhetorical synthesis**

The goal is size, and the length and the count of individual reefs are the size facts in the notes. The other choices give a date, a location, or a claim not in the notes.

26 **Choice A** **Rhetorical synthesis**

The audience already knows the author, so the best choice names the book and says what it covers. The others either re-introduce the author or leave out the title.

27 **Choice C** **Rhetorical synthesis**

The goal is significance, and only the correct choice says why the notes matter: they contain what many consider the first published computer program. The others give dates or a bare description.

Answer explanations

SAT Practice Test 1, Reading and Writing, Module 2

Questions 1 to 14

1 **Choice B** Words in context

The word despite signals a contrast with the guarded final report, so the earlier praise must have been warm and unrestrained. Effusive means that. The other three describe praise that is weak or reluctant, which would not contrast with a cautious report.

2 **Choice D** Words in context

The historians quoted the diary freely and its authority was questioned only after the discovery, so they had treated it as trustworthy. Reliable fits. A source thought controversial or negligible would not have been quoted freely.

3 **Choice A** Words in context

The colon introduces a long list of details recorded for each specimen, which shows thoroughness. Brevity is the opposite, and nothing in the list suggests ambiguity or an informal tone.

4 **Choice C** Words in context

A lake whose chemistry barely shifts, even in a drought, is stable. Volatile means the reverse, and porous and scarce do not describe chemical balance.

5 **Choice D** Text structure and purpose

The underlined sentence rejects the idea that the flourishes were mere decoration and the next sentence says what they show about mapmakers' attitudes. It does not concede that they were ornament, offer a counterexample, or discuss survey methods.

6 **Choice C** Text structure and purpose

The quick packing and the idea that the room feels like an accusation show Ansel's unease at how little there is to carry. The text gives no reason for the move, no change of mind and no suggestion that anyone else values his things.

7 **Choice D** Cross-text connections

Text 2 finds that home use between generations, not economic incentive, best predicts survival, so the sociolinguist would say Text 1 underrates the family. The sociolinguist does not rule out schooling or claim that small communities cannot succeed.

8 **Choice B** Central ideas and details

The text rejects the older idea that pigment simply wore away and proposes that switching it off saves energy and so is an advantage. The genes remain intact, and nothing compares cave fish with other fish as study subjects or calls pigment the costliest process.

9 **Choice A** Central ideas and details

The text argues that circulation counts only books leaving and misses the other uses of the building. It does not recommend ending lending, says nothing about most visitors reading newspapers, and says the library may be busier, not quieter.

10 **Choice C** Command of evidence: quantitative

The graph shows the count at 452 in 2021 and 610 in 2023. The rise is 158, which is about 35 percent of 452, so the sharp rise is correct. The other choices misstate the size of the change, its direction, or the years.

11 **Choice D** Command of evidence: quantitative

The claim needs a rise among nearby students and no rise among those farther away. Only the first choice gives both. One choice shows both groups rising, one reverses the direction, and the last compares the groups at a single point rather than over time.

12 **Choice A** Command of evidence: textual

The claim is about a contrast between early and late work, and only the quotation about abandoning the domestic scale states that contrast directly. The others describe the early reputation or a detail of one late scene without contrasting the two.

13 **Choice C** Command of evidence: textual

The claim concerns flying without rest for over a week, and a recorded eleven days with no landing supports it directly. Distance, weight change and shared routes do not show that the bird never stopped.

14 **Choice C** Inferences

A thermometer on a sunlit wall reads warmer than the air, and most early instruments were placed that way, so the records may run high. Nothing suggests falsification, and the text says records were kept in northern towns.

Answer explanations

SAT Practice Test 1, Reading and Writing, Module 2

Questions 15 to 27

15 Choice B Inferences

If wider roads simply attract more traffic, adding capacity will not cure congestion, and giving people other ways to travel is the logical remedy. The text does not recommend removing roads, and wider roads increased driving rather than lowering it.

16 Choice D Form, structure, and sense

The subject is the plural ceramics, which needs a plural verb. The passive construction are distinguished by completes the sentence. Is distinguished does not agree, and the other options fail to give a complete verb.

17 Choice D Boundaries

With neither or nor, the verb agrees with the nearer subject, engineers, which is plural. Was, is and has been are all singular.

18 Choice A Form, structure, and sense

The participle discovering attaches to the main clause and completes it correctly. Discovered would create a second main verb without a conjunction, she discovered would be a run-on, and and discovering breaks the parallel construction.

19 Choice B Form, structure, and sense

With two routes, the comparative less than is correct, and cost is an amount, not a count. The other options are not idiomatic.

20 Choice C Boundaries

The subject is the singular scientist; along with her colleagues is a parenthetical phrase that does not make the subject plural. The past tense presented agrees with the singular subject and the past event in March. Were presenting and have presented do not fit.

21 Choice D Boundaries

The relative pronoun must show possession of grandmother, so whose is required. Who's means who is, and whom and which do not show possession.

22 Choice C Transitions

The sentence draws a conclusion from the unevenness just described, so Consequently is the logical link. Instead and Likewise do not fit the relationship, and Previously refers to time.

23 Choice B Transitions

The later critics reached the opposite judgement from the early reviewers, so by contrast is the correct transition. The others suggest an example, a restatement or a consequence.

24 Choice A Transitions

The sentence sets the neglected lute against the much-studied violin, so By contrast is the logical transition.

25 Choice B Rhetorical synthesis

Scale is shown by figures for area and cost, which the first choice gives. The other choices describe the mill's history or the timing of the project without its size.

26 Choice D Rhetorical synthesis

To introduce readers to the author, the choice must name Wen Zhao and say who they are, which only the first does. The others describe the book without identifying its author.

27 Choice C Rhetorical synthesis

The goal is to explain a benefit, and only the first choice links the effect on nitrogen to the reduced need for fertiliser. The others define the practice or give half the explanation.

Answer explanations

SAT Practice Test 1, Math, Module 1

Questions 1 to 11

1 **Choice B** Data analysis

Club 4 has 40 members and Club 3 has 18, and 40 minus 18 is 22.

2 **Choice B** Percentages

35% of 240 is 0.35 times 240, which is 84.

3 **Choice C** Linear equations

Subtracting 3x from both sides gives 2x − 12 = 10. Adding 12 gives 2x = 22, so x = 11.

4 **Choice A** Linear equations in context

The fee is paid once, so it is the constant 30. The $18 repeats each month, so it multiplies m. The total is 18m + 30.

5 **Choice C** Systems of equations

Adding the equations gives 2x = 20, so x = 10. The value 4 is y.

6 **Choice D** Functions

Each step of 1 in x adds 3 to f(x), so the slope is 3. Then f(1) = 7 gives 3 + 4 = 7, so the intercept is 4.

7 **Choice C** Triangles

The angles of a triangle add to 180°, so x + 2x + 3x = 6x = 180 and x = 30.

8 **Choice D** Probability

40 students take the bus and 20 of them are in Grade 10, so the probability is 20/40 = 1/2. The value 2/5 uses all 50 Grade 10 students.

9 **Choice B** Statistics

The first five scores total 400, and adding 92 gives 492. Divided by 6 the mean is 82.

10 **Choice C** Scatterplots

Substitute x = 7: 6(7) + 40 = 42 + 40 = 82.

11 **Choice A** Inequalities

The total is the 45 already signed up plus 15 per week, and it must be at least 120, so the inequality is 45 + 15w ≥ 120.

Answer explanations

SAT Practice Test 1, Math, Module 1

Questions 12 to 22

12 **Choice D** **Functions**

f(3) = 2(9) − 9 + 1 = 18 − 9 + 1 = 10.

13 **Choice B** **Exponential functions**

Doubling every 3 hours means the number of doublings is t/3, so the population is 500 times 2 to the power t/3.

14 **Choice B** **Systems of equations in context**

Let a be adult tickets. Then 12a + 7(120 − a) = 1,090, so 5a + 840 = 1,090 and a = 50.

15 **Choice C** **Radicals**

Squaring both sides gives x + 7 = 25, so x = 18. The value 25 is the square of 5, not x.

16 **Choice A** **Linear functions**

The slope is (9 − 3)/(4 − 1) = 2. Using (1, 3), 3 = 2(1) + b gives b = 1.

17 **28** **Linear equations**

Let the number be n. Then (3/4)n = 21, so n = 21 times 4/3 = 28.

18 **63** **Area**

The area of a triangle is half the base times the height: (1/2)(14)(9) = 63.

19 **30** **Percent change**

The increase is 12 dollars, and 12 divided by the original 40 is 0.30, which is 30 percent.

20 **8** **Quadratics**

The equation factors as (x − 8)(x + 2) = 0, so the solutions are 8 and −2. The positive one is 8.

21 **90** **Volume**

The volume is $\pi r^2 h = \pi(9)(10) = 90\pi$, so k = 90.

22 **12** **Right triangles**

By the Pythagorean theorem, the other leg is √(169 − 25) = √144 = 12.

Answer explanations

SAT Practice Test 1, Math, Module 2

Questions 1 to 11

1 **Choice D** Functions

f(4) = 3(16) − 32 + 4 = 48 − 32 + 4 = 20.

2 **Choice A** Systems of equations

Adding the equations gives 2x = 20, so x = 10.

3 **Choice C** Quadratics

The equation factors as (x − 6)(x + 8) = 0, so x = 6 or x = −8.

4 **Choice B** Percentages

20% of 160 is 0.2 times 160, which is 32.

5 **Choice D** Exponential functions

Doubling every 6 hours means the number of doublings is t/6, so the population is 300 times 2 to the power t/6.

6 **Choice C** Linear functions

The slope is (16 − 7)/(4 − 1) = 3. Using (1, 7), 7 = 3(1) + b gives b = 4.

7 **Choice A** Scatterplots

Substitute x = 8: 4(8) + 33 = 32 + 33 = 65.

8 **Choice B** Surface area

Each cube has 6 faces, and gluing two faces together hides 2 of the 12, leaving 10 faces of area s^2. So $10s^2 = 640$, $s^2 = 64$, and s = 8.

9 **Choice A** Circles

Arc length is the radius times the central angle in radians: 12 × π/4 = 3π.

10 **Choice C** Trigonometry

A right triangle with opposite side 5 and hypotenuse 13 has adjacent side 12, so tan A = opposite/adjacent = 5/12.

11 **Choice D** Percentages

Start at 100. After the 20% rise the price is 120, and 30% off 120 leaves 84. That is 16% lower than the original.

Answer explanations

SAT Practice Test 1, Math, Module 2

Questions 12 to 22

12 **Choice B** **Absolute value**

The inequality means x is within 5 of 8, so $3 \le x \le 13$. That range has 11 integers, counting both ends.

13 **Choice D** **Exponential equations**

Write 4 as 2^2, so the right side is 2^(2x − 6). Equal bases give $x + 1 = 2x - 6$, so $x = 7$.

14 **Choice B** **Percentages**

70 is 50 more than 20, and 50 / 20 = 2.5, so p = 250.

15 **Choice C** **Exponential functions**

A year is 12 months, so the value is multiplied by 0.7^(12/6) = 0.7^2 = 0.49 each year. That is a decrease of 1 − 0.49, or 51%.

16 **Choice A** **Statistics**

Multiplying by 2 multiplies the mean and the standard deviation by 2; adding 8 moves the mean by 8 but does not change the spread. The mean of A is 6.8, so the mean of B is 21.6, which is 14.8 greater. The standard deviation of B is 2 times that of A.

17 **22** **Systems of equations**

Adding $x + y = 29$ and $x - y = 15$ gives $2x = 44$, so the larger number is 22.

18 **4** **Quadratics**

For $ax^2 + bx + c = 0$ the solutions add to $-b/a = -(-12)/3 = 4$.

19 **4** **Circles in the plane**

Complete the square: $(x + 6)^2 + (y + 5)^2 = -45 + 36 + 25 = 16$. The radius is $\sqrt{16} = 4$.

20 **26** **Quadratics**

The maximum is at $t = -b/(2a) = 8/2 = 4$. Then $h(4) = -1(16) + 32 + 10 = 26$.

21 **10** **Quadratics**

Exactly one real solution means the discriminant is zero: $b^2 - 4(25) = 0$, so $b^2 = 100$ and $b = 10$ (taking the positive value).

22 **8** **Systems with nonlinear equations**

Setting the expressions equal gives $x^2 - 2x + (9 - k) = 0$. One solution means the discriminant is 0: $4 - 4(9 - k) = 0$, so $k = 8$.